

**Listing 3.5 Adding a view for the news page**

```
# RiffMates/home/views.py
from django.shortcuts import render
...
def news(request):
    data = {
        'news': [
            "RiffMates now has a news page!",
            "RiffMates has its first web page",
        ],
    }

    return render(request, "news.html", data)
```

Like all views, `news()` must be registered as a route. You need a path object inside `RiffMates/RiffMates/urls.py` for the `news()` view, similar to how you did for `credits()`. Add the new path object to `urlpatterns`, like in the following listing.

**Listing 3.6 Registering the `news()` view as a route**

```
# RiffMates/RiffMates/urls.py
...
urlpatterns = [
    ...
    path('news/', home_views.news, name="news"),
]
```

← New path object mapping `"news/"` to the `news()` view

The `render()` shortcut in the `news()` view looks for an HTML template named `news.html`. Before creating that template, you must tell Django where to look for templates. You do this by modifying the `TEMPLATES` configuration in `RiffMates/RiffMates/settings.py`. The `TEMPLATES` value is a dictionary containing four keys that control how templates work in Django:

- **BACKEND** *specifies which template engine to use in your project.* Django ships with the original Django Template Engine as well as a popular third-party template engine, named Jinja2. You can also install other third-party engines if you prefer. I'll be sticking with the default throughout this book.
- **DIRS** *is a list of directories in which Django looks for templates.*
- **APP\_DIRS** *is a Boolean value.* When `True` (the default), Django will look for template directories within the app directories. Note that the apps are searched in order of their appearance in the `INSTALLED_APPS` configuration value.
- **OPTIONS** *is a nested dictionary to pass configuration options to the template engine.* The default values for this are sufficient.

By default, the `DIRS` property is an empty list and needs to be changed to wherever you decide to put your templates. The most common place to put your templates is in your project folder in a directory named *templates*. Use your file explorer or the